the US, the worst since 1987, the Sensex plummeted 8.03 per cent (2,919 points).[12] More dominoes fell as the Indian Premier League (IPL), which was scheduled to begin soon, made an announcement that considering the coronavirus situation in the country, all scheduled matches would be postponed to 15 April at least, after which the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI) would consult with the government and other stakeholders to decide the schedule of matches.[13] The IPL is the biggest sporting event of the year in India, with thousands of crores of ad revenue and ticket sales at stake.

◆

Panic was quickly spreading countrywide. Indians returning home from oversees were falling sick and many were presenting in emergency wards of hospitals with complaints of shortness of breath. In the absence of guidelines from the state government, private hospitals were admitting these patients, without being equipped to handle COVID-19 cases. They hadn't created isolation wards, or trained the staff on SOPs to follow for appropriate handling of such cases.

Mr MP, a 64-year-old resident of an eastern suburb of Mumbai, had returned to India from the United Arab Emirates (UAE) on 6 March 2020. Following some increasing restlessness and shortness of breath, he presented himself at Hinduja Hospital in Mahim, Mumbai, where he was immediately admitted under the care of leading pulmonologist Dr Zarir Udwadia. Some pneumonia patches had shown up on his chest x-ray and he was being treated for pneumonia. Just to double check, the hospital had collected his nasal and throat swabs and sent them for COVID-19 testing. The authorities were so sure that he just had a bad case of pneumonia that they didn't fast-track testing. By the time the test results came back, it had been about four days and the patient had shown early signs of recovery. In early March, the samples had to be sent to NIV (Pune) and the turnaround time for the results to come back was anywhere between four to five days. He had tested positive for the novel coronavirus. The Maharashtra state government guidelines at that point had disallowed private entities to treat COVID-19 patients. Thus, in a hurry, in the following few hours of MP testing positive, he was shifted to the government-run Kasturba Gandhi Hospital, where he was placed in a separate isolation room. All his primary